

L4 Learning Resources and Engagement

Merged worksheet. Absorbs L5 (Organising Learning Tools) and L8 (Making Learning Relevant and Engaging). This is now the single worksheet for selecting, organising, and engaging with learning resources.

Pillar	Learning	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	35-45 minutes	Group Size	4-12 or individual
Mode	Team facilitation or solo	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	L1 (Skills Diagnostic) to identify what to learn	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Overwhelmed by too many resources, lack of accessible learning tools, low engagement in learning programs, decision fatigue around development options

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Decision fatigue is neurologically real. Each decision the brain makes depletes the same cognitive resources used for learning. When employees face 50 learning options without guidance on which ones matter, the brain's response is often paralysis: no decision is made, no learning happens. This is the paradox of choice applied to professional development.

Engagement with learning resources is also a dopamine question. Resources that match the learner's preferred format, connect to real work challenges, and provide visible progress signals keep dopamine flowing. Resources that feel irrelevant, passive, or disconnected from work produce no reward signal, and the brain abandons them.

The Exercise

Phase 1: Resource Audit (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"How many learning resources do you currently have access to? Count everything: company training platforms, online courses you've bookmarked, books on your shelf, podcasts in your queue, mentoring relationships. Write down every resource you could theoretically use for development."

Most people are surprised by the count. Then the reality check: "Of those, how many have you actively used in the last month?" The gap between available and used is usually enormous.

Phase 2: The Three-Filter Sort (10 minutes)

For each resource on the list, apply three filters in order:

1. Relevance: does this directly address one of my L1 priority gaps? (Yes/No)
2. Format fit: does this match how I actually learn? (If you learn by doing and the resource is a 40-hour video course, it's a mismatch regardless of quality.)
3. Time reality: can I realistically engage with this in the next month given my workload? (Yes/No)

Resources that pass all three filters go on the active list. Everything else goes on the 'future' list or gets cut entirely. The goal is to reduce the active list to 2-3 resources maximum.

Phase 3: Engagement Design (10 minutes)

For each resource on the active list, design the engagement:

- When will I use it? (specific day/time, anchored to existing routine)
- How will I make it active, not passive? (take notes, practise the skill, discuss with a colleague, apply to a real project)
- What's my progress marker? (not 'finish the course' but 'be able to do X that I couldn't do before')

FACILITATION NOTE

The progress marker question is the most important. "Complete the course" is a completion metric, not a learning metric. "Be able to build a pivot table without looking up the steps" is a competence metric. The brain responds to competence gains with dopamine. It responds to completion with a brief satisfaction spike that quickly fades.

Phase 4: Team Resource Sharing (5 minutes)

Go round the team: each person names their top resource and why they chose it. This creates a team knowledge base of recommended resources and often surfaces options that people didn't know existed.

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
Someone has no learning resources available	This is an enablement issue, not a learning issue. "That's worth flagging. Let's identify what you need and I'll work on getting access." Connect to E5 (Access to Technology/Resources) if this is a systemic problem.
The team's learning platform is mandated but poorly rated	Acknowledge reality: "If the mandatory platform isn't working for people, that's useful data. Let's separate what's required from what's effective, and supplement the required training with resources that

	actually help."
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Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
L1: Skills Diagnostic	L1 identifies WHAT to learn. L4 identifies HOW to learn it efficiently.	Run L1 before L4
L6: Accountability	L4 selects the resources; L6 builds the structure to ensure they get used.	Run L4 then L6
L7: Real-World Application	L4's engagement design should connect directly to L7's application framework.	Complementary
E5: Technology/Resources	If resource access is the barrier, E5 addresses the enablement gap.	Use E5 for systemic access issues